

72nd BPSC PRELIMS

प्रहार

Test Series

Test- 14

Current Affairs

Solution

English



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BPSC TEST-14 (SOLUTION)

Q 1. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Passive euthanasia does not involve the administration of lethal substances. The deliberate administration of a lethal substance or force to end a life is classified as active euthanasia, which remains illegal in India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Passive euthanasia specifically involves the withdrawal or withholding of life sustaining medical treatments or life support systems, allowing a terminally ill patient to die naturally from the underlying medical condition.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Passive euthanasia is legally permissible in India. The Supreme Court of India legalized the practice in the 2018 Common Cause versus Union of India judgment. The apex court ruled that the right to die with dignity is an intrinsic component of the fundamental right to life enshrined in Article 21 of the Constitution, subject to strict procedural safeguards and medical board approvals.

Q 2. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Essential Commodities Act of 1955 was enacted to ensure the uninterrupted supply of specific commodities to consumers at fair prices and to prevent market malpractices such as hoarding and black marketing.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Central Government holds the statutory authority to modify the schedule of essential commodities. It can actively add or remove items from the regulatory list based on prevailing market conditions, supply shortages, and broader public interest.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Central Government delegates the implementation and enforcement powers to State Governments and Union Territories. State administrative authorities are legally empowered to issue control orders, specify stock limits, and execute search and seizure operations against violating entities to enforce compliance.

Q 3. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Nucleic Acid Testing detects the specific genetic material, such as DNA or RNA,

of targeted pathogens directly. This differs from traditional serological tests that rely on identifying antigens or antibodies produced by the human immune system in response to an infection.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The primary clinical advantage of Nucleic Acid Testing is its exceptionally high sensitivity, which allows it to detect infections during the window period. The window period represents the early phase of an infection when the pathogen is present and multiplying, but standard antibody tests cannot yet yield a positive result.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Nucleic Acid Testing is widely mandated and implemented in blood banks for screening donated blood. It is specifically utilized to detect transfusion transmissible infections such as the Human Immunodeficiency Virus, Hepatitis B, and Hepatitis C, thereby significantly enhancing the safety of the blood supply.

Q 4. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Fiscal Health Index 2026 was officially released by NITI Aayog. The index provides a comprehensive and comparable assessment of the fiscal performance of Indian states to evaluate fiscal soundness and guide reforms.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Odisha retained the first position among eighteen major states for the second consecutive year in the 2026 index. The state secured a leading score driven by high quality expenditure, prudent fiscal management, and a strong debt profile.

Q 5. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The G Spider robotic system has been deployed by the Thiruvananthapuram Municipal Corporation in Kerala for the mechanised cleaning of the Amayizhanchan canal. It was introduced under the Swachh Bharat Mission Urban 2.0 to eliminate hazardous manual scavenging in confined urban drainage networks.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The system is built on a Cable Driven Parallel Robotics architecture. It integrates artificial intelligence enabled vision systems and sensors to autonomously detect, assess, and remove accumulated waste directly into collection vehicles.

Q 6. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In a landmark judgment delivered in March 2026, the Supreme Court ruled that adoptive mothers are entitled to twelve weeks of maternity leave. The Court emphasized that maternity benefits extend to all forms of motherhood and are essential for caregiving and family integration.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Supreme Court struck down the statutory restriction that limited maternity benefits only to cases where the adopted child was below three months of age. The Court declared this age cap under Section 60(4) of the Code on Social Security, 2020, as arbitrary, discriminatory, and unconstitutional, thereby extending the twelve week benefit to all adoptive mothers regardless of the child's age.

Q 7. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Resilience and Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation Scheme seeks to support Indian exporters impacted by maritime disruptions in the West Asia corridor. It ensures continuity by providing up to one hundred percent risk coverage while maintaining export insurance premiums at pre conflict rates, with the government subsidizing the additional costs.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme is implemented by the Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India rather than the Export Import Bank. The Export Credit Guarantee Corporation acts as the central nodal agency tasked with verifying claims, disbursing funds, and mitigating war related risks for exporters.

Q 8. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Freedom Shield 2026 is an annual combined military exercise conducted by the United States and South Korea.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Lamitiye 2026 is a joint military exercise conducted between the Indian Armed Forces and the Seychelles Defence Forces.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Cold Response 2026 is a Norwegian led winter military exercise that involves the participation of NATO and allied forces.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** Exercise Sea Dragon is

a United States led multinational military exercise designed to train participating nations in anti submarine warfare tactics.

Q 9. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The World Happiness Report 2026 is a publication of the Wellbeing Research Centre at the University of Oxford, produced in partnership with the United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network and Gallup.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Finland was ranked as the happiest country in the world for the ninth consecutive year in the 2026 report. Denmark secured the third position in the global rankings.

Q 10. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** The International Solar Alliance is headquartered in Gurugram, India.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The International Energy Agency is headquartered in Paris, France.
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** The International Atomic Energy Agency is headquartered in Vienna, Austria, rather than Geneva, Switzerland.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** The Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity is located in Montreal, Canada.

Q 11. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** The Strait of Hormuz is a strategically vital waterway that connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** Kharg Island is located in the northeastern part of the Persian Gulf, serving as a principal maritime crude oil export terminal for Iran, rather than in the Red Sea.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Diego Garcia is an atoll located in the central Indian Ocean and is the largest island comprising the Chagos Archipelago.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** The Rub al Khali, also known as the Empty Quarter, encompasses a significant portion of the southern Arabian Peninsula and is geographically classified as the largest continuous sand desert in the world.

Q 12. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Operation Sankalp

is a maritime security initiative launched by the Indian Navy to ensure the safety of Indian flagged merchant vessels and maintain stability in the Indian Ocean Region.

- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Operation Epic Fury was initiated by the United States Armed Forces in February 2026 to target and destroy Iranian offensive missiles and security infrastructure.
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** Operation Himrahat was a high altitude rescue mission conducted by the Indian Army in February 2026 to safely evacuate stranded tourists in East Sikkim following severe snowfall, rather than a naval evacuation from the Gulf of Aden.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** Project HANUMAN was introduced by the Government of Andhra Pradesh on World Wildlife Day 2026 to systematically mitigate human wildlife conflict through structured rescue, treatment, and monitoring efforts.

Q 13. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Kavach 4.0 is an indigenous Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system developed by Indian Railways to prevent train collisions by automatically controlling speed and applying brakes in case of signal violation or unsafe conditions.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** NavIC (Navigation with Indian Constellation) is India's regional navigation satellite system developed by ISRO to provide accurate positioning and timing services over India and surrounding regions.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Pratibimb Module is a crime-mapping and analytics tool used by law enforcement agencies for geospatial crime analysis and data-driven policing to improve investigation and security planning.

Q 14. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Legionnaires' disease is a severe form of pneumonia caused by Legionella bacteria, making it a bacterial infection.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Mumps is an acute viral disease caused by the mumps virus, primarily affecting the salivary glands.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Cassava Brown Streak Disease was first identified in East Africa and is a viral disease affecting cassava crops, causing major agricultural losses.

- **Pair 4 is incorrectly matched:** Chile is not the first country in the Americas to eliminate leprosy; leprosy elimination milestones have been achieved at different times across countries, and WHO has not recognised Chile specifically as the first in the Americas.

Q 15. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** THAAD (Terminal High Altitude Area Defense) is a mobile missile defence system designed to intercept and destroy short, medium, and intermediate-range ballistic missiles during their terminal phase.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** Pinaka is a multi-barrel rocket launcher system developed by DRDO and is not an anti-tank guided missile system. It is used for area saturation strikes and has been inducted into the Indian Armed Forces for artillery support roles.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** PRACHAND is the indigenous Light Combat Helicopter (LCH) developed by HAL and inducted into the Indian Air Force and Army. It is designed for high-altitude operations, close air support, and anti-tank warfare in difficult terrains such as Siachen and Ladakh.
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** AVATAAR is an amphibious autonomous drone developed for multi-domain operations, including surveillance and reconnaissance over land and water. It is designed to enhance situational awareness in complex operational environments and support unmanned mission capabilities.

Q 16. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** The Mark Lynton History Prize 2026 was awarded to historian William Dalrymple for his outstanding contribution to historical writing and scholarship, particularly on Indian and Asian history.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The Stockholm Water Prize 2026 was awarded to Kaveh Madani for his contributions to water governance, sustainability, and climate-resilient water management. The prize is regarded as the "Nobel Prize for Water".
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** The Jnanpith Award is India's highest literary honour, and while Damodar Mauzo is a previous recipient (2022), he is not the recipient of the 60th Jnanpith Award.

Q 17. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** India and Israel have elevated their bilateral relationship to a Strategic Partnership (often described as Special Strategic Partnership in official communications), reflecting deeper cooperation in defence, agriculture, water, innovation, and security domains.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Both countries have agreed in principle to explore integration of India's UPI (Unified Payments Interface) with Israel's MASAV payment system, aimed at enhancing digital financial connectivity and easing cross-border transactions.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** While cooperation in cyber security is part of India-Israel ties, the specific proposal of establishing a Cyber Centre of Excellence in Israel is not part of the recent formal agreements; such initiatives are generally collaborative and not limited to a single fixed institutional creation in Israel.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Israel has expressed interest in increasing the employment of Indian workers, with discussions indicating potential deployment of up to 50,000 additional Indian workers, particularly in sectors like construction and caregiving

Q 18. Ans. A

Explanation:

- On June 22, 2025, the United States Air Force and Navy conducted strikes on three nuclear facilities in Iran, namely the Fordow Uranium Enrichment Plant, the Natanz Nuclear Facility, and the Isfahan Nuclear Technology Center, under the codename **Operation Midnight Hammer**. The operation used GBU-57A/B "bunker buster" bombs, among the most powerful conventional munitions in the US arsenal, to target Iran's underground nuclear infrastructure.
- The strikes were described by President Trump as a limited, targeted mission aimed at Iran's nuclear program. US officials stated that all three sites sustained significant damage, though assessments of the extent varied between US, Israeli, Iranian, and IAEA sources.
- **Operation Epic Fury** was a separate, broader joint US-Israeli military campaign launched on February 28, 2026, targeting Iranian missiles, air defenses, wider military infrastructure, and Iranian leadership, and is therefore distinct from the

nuclear-site strikes.

- **Operation Sankalp** was an Indian Naval operation launched in 2019 in the Gulf of Oman to ensure the safe passage of Indian-flagged vessels amid rising tensions in the region, and has no connection to US strikes on Iran.
- **Operation Rahat** was an Indian evacuation operation conducted in 2015 to rescue Indian nationals and foreign citizens stranded in Yemen during the civil war there.

Q 19. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Diego Garcia is a joint US-UK military base in the Indian Ocean that hosts nuclear-capable B-2 Spirit stealth bombers. Britain initially refused to allow the base to be used for US-Israeli attacks on Iran, but later permitted American bombers to use Diego Garcia and another British base to target Iran's missile sites, specifically those being used to attack ships in the Strait of Hormuz.
- Diego Garcia has a runway over 3,600 metres long capable of launching strategic bombers. It also houses a deep-water port for nuclear submarines and naval vessels, along with control centres, air defence systems, and advanced intelligence facilities. The B-2 Spirit stealth bomber can fly sorties of over 40 hours and be refuelled mid-air, making the distance from Iran to Diego Garcia operationally manageable.
- Djibouti and Camp Lemonnier refer to the same facility. Camp Lemonnier, located in Djibouti, is the only permanent US military base in Africa and is primarily used for counterterrorism operations in the Horn of Africa and the Arabian Peninsula. It was not reported as a launch base for strikes against Iran in 2026.
- Al Udeid Air Base in Qatar was actually a target of Iranian retaliation, not a launch point for US offensive strikes. Iran fired missiles at Al Udeid in response to US strikes on its nuclear facilities during the Twelve-Day War in 2025.

Q 20. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** SabhaSaar is an AI-based tool that converts Gram Sabha meeting recordings into structured written minutes and official documents, helping in accurate documentation of local governance proceedings. It improves transparency and reduces manual workload in preparing official records.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Kisan e-Mitra is an AI-enabled virtual assistant designed to assist farmers by providing real-time information on government schemes, crop advisories, and agricultural services. It helps bridge the information gap between farmers and government support systems through conversational AI.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** eGramSwaraj is an integrated digital platform for Panchayats that supports planning, budgeting, accounting, and monitoring of rural development activities in a single system. It strengthens e-governance at the grassroots level by improving efficiency and transparency in Panchayat administration.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** BharatGen is not India's first privately funded English-only large language model. It is part of broader indigenous AI and multilingual initiatives aimed at developing inclusive language technologies for India's diverse linguistic ecosystem. Its description as a private, English-only LLM

Q 21. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Employees' Pension Scheme (EPS) 2026 is part of the broader transition under the Social Security Code framework, which subsumes and updates older labour welfare schemes such as EPS 1995 to create a unified social security system for workers.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The wage ceiling under EPS is not revised to ₹25,000 in the scheme framework. The existing statutory wage ceiling under EPS has historically been lower (₹15,000), and any revision requires formal notification by the government. Hence, this statement is not correct as per official provisions.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The minimum pension under EPS continues to be ₹1,000 per month, as ensured by government notifications to provide basic social security to pensioners in the unorganised and organised sectors covered under EPFO.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Pension calculation under EPS is based on the average salary of the last 60 months of service, which replaced earlier provisions of shorter averaging periods to provide a more stable pension computation framework.

Q 22. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** NICDIT (National Industrial

Corridor Development and Implementation Trust) is the apex body responsible for planning, approving, and overseeing industrial corridor development projects in India. It provides strategic direction for corridor-based industrialisation under the Government of India.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** NICDC (National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation Limited) is the principal implementing agency responsible for execution and development of industrial corridor nodes and associated infrastructure projects. It works under the guidance of NICDIT.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Special Economic Zones (SEZs) within industrial corridors are designed to attract domestic and foreign investment by offering tax incentives, simplified regulations, and world-class infrastructure, thereby boosting manufacturing and export competitiveness.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** PM Gati Shakti is not limited to international maritime trade routes. It is a national master plan for multi-modal connectivity covering roads, railways, ports, airports, logistics, and inland waterways to improve infrastructure planning and reduce logistics costs across India.

Q 23. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) aims to bring about the sustainable development of the fisheries sector through modernization of infrastructure, strengthening value chains, and enhancing the income of fishers and fish farmers.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** PMMSY is not solely a Central Sector Scheme. It is implemented as both a Central Sector Scheme and a Centrally Sponsored Scheme, involving both the Union and State Governments in implementation.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The scheme supports modern aquaculture practices such as biofloc technology, recirculatory aquaculture systems (RAS), and seaweed cultivation, aimed at improving productivity and sustainability in fisheries.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** India permits up to 49% FDI in fisheries and deep-sea fishing activities under the automatic route, aimed at attracting investment and improving technological capability in the sector.

Q 24. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Tribes Art Fest 2026 was organised in New

Delhi as part of national efforts to showcase and promote tribal art, culture, and heritage. It provides a platform for tribal artisans, performers, and cultural groups from across India to display their traditional art forms, crafts, and performances. Such initiatives are supported by the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, aiming to preserve indigenous cultural identity while also linking tribal art with wider national and global audiences

Q 25. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Chandigarh has been declared the second fully literate Union Territory after achieving high literacy coverage under government initiatives such as the ULLAS (Understanding of Lifelong Learning for All in Society) programme. The achievement reflects sustained adult education efforts, strong implementation of foundational literacy programmes, and coordinated participation of local administration. It highlights India's progress towards improving literacy and educational inclusivity at the grassroots level.

Q 26. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Kalbelia community is primarily associated with the Thar Desert region of Rajasthan. Traditionally known for snake charming, the community is also famous for its distinctive folk dance form, Kalbelia dance, which reflects their cultural expressions and nomadic heritage. The dance and music traditions of the Kalbelia community have been recognised globally and are included in UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list, highlighting their cultural significance.

Q 27. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Centre for Railway Information Systems (CRIS) is developing the 'RailOne' super application for Indian Railways. CRIS functions as the technology arm of Indian Railways and is responsible for designing, developing, and maintaining key digital platforms such as ticketing systems, freight management, and operational databases. The RailOne app is aimed at integrating multiple railway services into a single digital platform to enhance passenger convenience and operational efficiency.

Q 28. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Controller General of Accounts (CGA) operates under the Ministry of Finance, Department of Expenditure. It is the apex authority for accounting functions of the Central Government and is responsible for preparing monthly and annual accounts of the Union Government. The CGA also plays a key role in maintaining transparency in public financial management and ensuring accurate accounting of government expenditure and receipts.

Q 29. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The INSV Kaundinya is an Indian Naval Sailing Vessel that undertook a historic stitched-boat voyage to Muscat in 2026, showcasing India's maritime heritage and ancient shipbuilding traditions. The voyage highlighted traditional navigation techniques combined with modern naval endurance capabilities, reflecting India's revival of indigenous maritime knowledge systems.

Q 30. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The book 'Mahatma: A Great Communicator' is authored by Gopalkrishna Gandhi, who has written extensively on Indian history and public life. The book focuses on Mahatma Gandhi's communication style, including his speeches, writings, and ability to connect with masses through simplicity and moral clarity. It also highlights Gandhi's simplicity of expression, moral persuasion, and ability to connect with diverse sections of society, making him one of the most effective communicators in modern history.

Q 31. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Karbi Anglong Ginger has been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) tag and is associated with the Karbi Anglong region of Assam. It is known for its high-quality rhizomes, strong aroma, and rich medicinal properties, making it highly valued in both domestic and international markets.
- The GI recognition helps protect the uniqueness of this indigenous product and supports the livelihood of local tribal farmers in Assam by enhancing its market value and brand identity.

Q 32. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Yatra Scheme has been launched by the Government of Maharashtra to promote awareness about the life, teachings, and legacy of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar. The scheme includes organised tours to important places associated with Ambedkar's life, including his birthplace, educational institutions, and sites linked to the Dalit movement.
- It aims to spread the values of social justice, equality, and constitutional morality among citizens, especially youth, while also promoting cultural and educational tourism in the state.

Q 33. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- The book 'Atal Bihari Vajpayee: The Eternal Statesman' is authored by Vijay Goel, a former Union Minister. The book presents a detailed account of Atal Bihari Vajpayee's political journey, leadership style, and contributions to India's governance and foreign policy.
- It highlights Vajpayee's reputation as a consensus-builder, his parliamentary eloquence, and his role in shaping modern India's political and diplomatic identity, making him one of the most respected statesmen in Indian history.

Q 34. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The PAIMANA portal, which stands for Project Assessment Infrastructure Monitoring and Analytics for Nation Building, is a digital initiative developed and launched by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
- It was officially launched on 25 September 2025 to replace the Online Computerized Monitoring System. The platform acts as a centralized data repository mandated to monitor and evaluate the status of ongoing central sector infrastructure projects with an estimated cost of 150 crore rupees and above.
- Through application programming interface integration with the Integrated Project Monitoring Portal, it automatically fetches data from various central ministries and implementing agencies to generate analytical reports. This integration substantially reduces manual data entry and enhances data accuracy, operational efficiency, and transparency in national infrastructure development planning.

Q 35. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- India became a signatory to the United States led Pax Silica initiative on 20 February 2026.
- The Pax Silica initiative is a strategic effort designed to establish a secure, resilient, and innovation driven supply chain for critical minerals and artificial intelligence.
- The partnership specifically targets the securing of the global silicon supply chain to prevent single source monopolies from dominating foundational materials necessary for advanced industries.
- This collaboration aligns with India's objective to secure long term access to critical minerals essential for clean energy and advanced manufacturing sectors.

Q 36. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Kaveh Madani became the youngest recipient of the Stockholm Water Prize in 2026 at the age of forty four. Serving as the Director of the United Nations University Institute for Water Environment and Health, he was recognized for his groundbreaking research integrating game theory and decision analysis into water resources management.
- His work shifted the global discourse from infrastructure to governance and popularized the concept of water bankruptcy to describe chronic and systemic water insecurity.

Q 37. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Dr Partha Sarathi Mahanta directed the animated short film CHYIMI, which secured the Best Director Award for the Winter 2026 season at the New York Short Animation Festival. The New York Short Animation Festival serves as a global platform celebrating creativity, originality, and technical excellence in animated filmmaking. The recognition of this film highlights the expanding influence of Indian animation and regional storytelling on international platforms. Dr Mahanta currently serves as the Inspector General of Police in Assam and the Commissioner of Police in Guwahati.

Q 38. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Conan O'Brien hosted the 98th Academy Awards on 15 March 2026. This marked his second consecutive year serving as the host for the ceremony.

Q 39. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Rashmika Mandanna received the Best Actress award at the Telangana Gaddar Film Awards for her performance in the film The Girlfriend. In the film, she portrayed the character Bhooma Devi.
- The awards ceremony took place on 19 March 2026, coinciding with Ugadi celebrations, and the accolade was presented to her by actor Ram Charan in the presence of Chief Minister Revanth Reddy.
- The Gaddar Film Awards are state backed honors established by the Government of Telangana to celebrate films reflecting the cultural and social ethos of the region.

Q 40. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Amol Palekar was conferred with the META Lifetime Achievement Award 2026 in recognition of his significant contribution to Indian theatre and cinema.
- The award was presented during the 21st edition of the Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards, which took place in New Delhi from 19 to 25 March 2026.
- Instituted by the Mahindra Group, the award honors individuals who have dedicated their lives to the enrichment of Indian theatre.

Q 41. Ans. C

Explanation:

- On March 4, 2026, the US Navy attack submarine USS Charlotte sank the Iranian Navy frigate IRIS Dena in international waters roughly 20 nautical miles off the southern coast of Sri Lanka. The Iranian warship had just participated in the multinational naval exercise MILAN 2026 and the International Fleet Review in India, and was returning home when it was struck by an MK-48 torpedo, resulting in rapid sinking within two to three minutes.
- The incident brought the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) into sharp focus. UNCLOS governs control of the seas and divides maritime spaces into distinct zones with varying degrees of sovereignty and rights, including the territorial sea extending up to 12 nautical miles and the Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) beyond it.
- Sri Lanka is one of the founding signatories of UNCLOS. Under Article 58 of UNCLOS, vessels may enjoy freedom of navigation within another

state's EEZ. However, these freedoms do not grant unlimited rights to conduct military operations that threaten the peace and security of the coastal state. Military engagement within another country's EEZ without its consent raises profound legal and political questions, and if the strike occurred within Sri Lanka's EEZ, it would represent a serious violation of the spirit of UNCLOS.

- While the law of naval warfare technically takes precedence over UNCLOS where the two come into tension, the incident nonetheless triggered a broader debate about the rules governing conduct at sea, obligations to rescue survivors, and the rights of neutral coastal states.
- MARPOL Convention deals with the prevention of marine pollution from ships and is not relevant to the legal questions raised by the sinking.
- London Convention pertains to the dumping of wastes at sea and has no bearing on naval warfare or rescue obligations.
- Paris MoU (Memorandum of Understanding) is a regional port state control regime focused on ship safety inspections in European waters and is entirely unrelated to the incident.

Q 42. Ans. B

Explanation:

- BIOFACH is the world's largest trade fair exclusively dedicated to organic food and agriculture, held annually in Nuremberg, Germany. India was designated the 'Country of the Year' at BIOFACH 2026, held from February 10 to 13, 2026.
- India's participation was organised by the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)**, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- This was India's return to centre stage at BIOFACH after **14 years**. The India Pavilion spanned **1,074 square metres**, a 50% increase over previous editions, and featured 67 co-exhibitors including exporters, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), and state government bodies.
- The recognition coincided with the conclusion of **EU-India Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** negotiations, expected to boost Indian organic exports to European markets.
- Germany hosts BIOFACH but is not a designated partner country. Brazil and Australia, while significant organic producers, had no such designation at BIOFACH 2026.

Q 43. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The first meeting of BRICS Sherpas and Sous-Sherpas under India's Chairship was held on **February 9-10, 2026, in New Delhi**.
- The meeting was chaired by **Sudhakar Dalela**, Secretary (Economic Relations) and India's BRICS Sherpa, supported by **Shambhu L. Hakki**, Joint Secretary (Multilateral Economic Relations) as Sous-Sherpa.
- Sherpas from all BRICS member and partner countries, namely Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and UAE, participated. On February 10, they jointly called on External Affairs Minister **S. Jaishankar**.
- India presented its priorities under the theme **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**, reflecting a people-centric and 'Humanity First' approach.
- This is India's **fourth BRICS Chairship**, having previously held it in 2012, 2016 and 2021. BRICS expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran and UAE, with Indonesia joining in 2025.

Q 44. Ans. A

Explanation:

- On **February 12, 2026**, Satendra Singh Lohiya, a para-swimmer from **Bhind district, Madhya Pradesh**, became the first Asian para-swimmer to cross the **Cook Strait, New Zealand**, one of the world's most challenging open-water sea channels. He covered **23.6 km in 9 hours and 22 minutes**.
- Lohiya has limited mobility in both legs due to inadequate treatment for diarrhoea in infancy. He is a recipient of the **Padma Shri (2024)** and the **Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award**.
- His earlier feats include crossing the **English Channel (2018)** and the **Catalina Channel (USA)**. He has also won 23 medals across 11 National Paralympic Swimming Championships.
- The Cook Strait separates the North and South Islands of New Zealand and is notorious for strong currents, cold temperatures, and unpredictable weather.

Q 45. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Aditya Pandya (17 years)**, from Gujarat, became India's youngest male analogue astronaut after completing a lunar habitat simulation mission

conducted by **AAKA Space Studio**, an ISRO-registered Space Tutor organisation, from **February 1 to 8, 2026**, at **Dholavira, Kutch, Gujarat**.

- The mission was a four-member crew exercise involving **8 days of complete isolation** inside a container-based lunar analog habitat, simulating Moon-like conditions of isolation, limited resources, and autonomous operations.
- Aditya served as lead for the mission's **hardware, IoT, and habitat intelligence systems**, and developed environmental sensors, biometric monitoring systems, and a Digital Twin Framework for real-time monitoring.
- **Dholavira** was chosen for its dry, white terrain resembling lunar geography. It is also a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** (Harappan civilisation), making it significant from both scientific and cultural standpoints, relevant for UPSC.
- The other options, **Sharath Gayakwad, Suyash Jadhav, and Murlikant Petkar**, are para-athletes unrelated to space research.

Q 46. 46.Ans. A

Explanation:

- Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** formally unveiled the mascots **"Pragati" (female enumerator)** and **"Vikas" (male enumerator)** for Census-2027 on **March 5, 2026**, in New Delhi, along with the soft-launch of four digital platforms developed by the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**.
- The mascots symbolise the **equal participation of women and men** in nation-building and the goal of a **Viksit Bharat by 2047**.
- Census-2027 will be India's **first fully digital census**, conducted in **two phases**: Phase 1 (House Listing Operations: April to September 2026) and Phase 2 (Population Enumeration: February 2027). It will be the world's largest census exercise, engaging over **30 lakh enumerators**.
- For the first time, citizens will have the option of **Self-Enumeration** via a dedicated digital portal. The census was originally due in **2021** but was postponed due to the COVID-19 pandemic.
- It is also notable that Census-2027 will include **caste enumeration**, a significant inclusion for social policy planning.

Q 47. Ans. B

Explanation:

- On **March 8, 2026**, Prime Minister Narendra

Modi inaugurated two new Delhi Metro corridors, completing India's first fully operational **Ring Metro in New Delhi**.

- The completion of the **12.3 km Majlis Park to Maujpur-Babarpur** stretch of the **Pink Line** closed the loop, extending the Pink Line to **71.56 km** and making it a continuous circular corridor around large parts of Delhi.
- The second corridor inaugurated was the **9.9 km Deepali Chowk to Majlis Park** extension of the **Magenta Line**, stretching it to approximately 49 km.
- The Ring Metro runs along Delhi's **Inner Ring Road**, allowing passengers to travel across North, East, and West Delhi without passing through central interchange stations, significantly reducing travel time between North-East and North-West Delhi.
- PM Modi also laid the foundation stone for **three new corridors under Delhi Metro Phase V-A**, including the Golden Line extension to IGI Airport Terminal-1 and the Ramakrishna Ashram Marg to Indraprastha Central Vista corridor.

Q 48. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Mayank Chakraborty (16 years)**, from Guwahati, Assam, became India's **94th Chess Grandmaster** and the **first ever from Northeast India** on **March 13, 2026**, by securing his final GM norm at the **8th GM Tournament, Hotel Stockholm North, Sweden**. He topped the field with **7/9 points** and crossed the mandatory **2500 FIDE Elo rating** threshold, with a rating performance of 2670.
- To earn the Grandmaster title, FIDE requires a player to achieve **three GM norms** and cross the **2500 Elo rating** mark. Mayank had earlier earned his International Master (IM) title in 2024.
- The achievement is historically significant as Northeast India, a region traditionally dominated by football and boxing, had no Grandmaster before Mayank.
- Regarding the other options: **Dibyendu Barua** was India's 3rd Grandmaster (1991) from West Bengal. **Praveen Thipsay** was India's 4th Grandmaster (1997) from Maharashtra. **Anurag Mhamal** is a prominent chess player from Goa but is unrelated to this achievement.

Q 49. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The 60th Jnanpith Award for the year 2025 has been conferred upon R. Vairamuthu, an eminent Tamil

poet, lyricist, and novelist, in recognition of his outstanding contributions to Tamil literature. With this honour, he becomes the third Tamil writer and the first Tamil poet to receive the award. The previous Tamil recipients were Akilan (1975) and D. Jayakanthan (2002), making this recognition the first for Tamil literature in 24 years.

- Vairamuthu has authored more than 37 books and has won seven National Film Awards over a career spanning four decades. He was awarded the Sahitya Akademi Award in 2003 for his novel Kallikattu Ithikasam, the Padma Shri in 2003, and the Padma Bhushan in 2014. His notable works include Karuvachi Kaviyam, Thanneer Desam, and Moondram Ulaga Por.
- The Jnanpith Award was instituted in 1961 by the Bharatiya Jnanpith, a cultural organisation established in 1944 by industrialist Sahu Shanti Prasad Jain and his wife Rama Jain. It is India's highest literary honour and is widely regarded as the equivalent of the Nobel Prize in Indian literature. The award carries a cash prize of Rs. 11 lakh, a citation, and a bronze statuette of Goddess Saraswati.

Q 50. Ans. B

Explanation:

- National Safety Day is observed every year on March 4 in India to commemorate the foundation of the National Safety Council of India (NSC) and to promote awareness about Safety, Health, and Environment (SHE) practices across workplaces and public spaces.
- The National Safety Council of India was established on March 4, 1966, by the Ministry of Labour and Employment as an autonomous body. The first National Safety Day campaign was launched in 1972.
- The observance marks the beginning of National Safety Week, which runs from March 4 to March 10, and in recent years has been extended into a National Safety Month covering the entirety of March.
- The theme for National Safety Day 2026 was "Engage, Educate and Empower People to Enhance Safety," marking the 55th edition of the campaign.

Q 51. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) deployed an in-house AI based surveillance system named "Sudarshan" to monitor the digital

ecosystem and identify misleading financial content posted by unregistered financial influencers, commonly known as finfluencers, across social media platforms.

- Sudarshan is capable of scanning large volumes of audio, video, and text content on a multilingual basis to detect patterns of unregistered investment advisory activity and false financial claims. Unlike traditional complaint based monitoring, it proactively flags suspicious content.
- In its initial phase, the system facilitated the removal of more than 1.2 lakh posts that were found to be in violation of SEBI norms. SEBI regulations mandate that only registered entities are permitted to provide investment advice.
- The tool was introduced under the chairmanship of Tuhin Kanta Pandey, who stated that the system enables SEBI to track and pinpoint transgressions across digital content formats.
- SEBI also introduced a statutory risk warning requiring that a pop-up message stating that nine out of ten retail investors lose money in options trading be displayed at the time of trading, drawing an analogy with health warnings on tobacco products.

Q 52. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Raisen Fort is located on a sandstone hill in Raisen town, Madhya Pradesh, approximately 40 km from Bhopal. It is one of the most prominent forts in the state and is a protected monument under the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI).
- The fort was built in the 11th century and served as a stronghold for Hindu rulers before passing through the control of the Sultans of Mandu, the Rajputs, the Mughals, and eventually the Nawabs of Bhopal. In 1543, Sher Shah Suri captured the fort from the Rajput ruler Puranmal.
- It came into recent news when police in Raisen district arrested four youths after a video surfaced on social media showing cannon firing from within the ASI protected fort premises, accompanied by alleged inflammatory slogans.
- The fort contains four palaces namely Badal Mahal, Rohini Mahal, Itradaan Mahal, and Hawa Mahal, along with more than 40 wells, rock shelters with ancient cave paintings, a Shiva temple, and the shrine of Muslim saint Hazrat Peer Fatehullah Shah Baba, making it a notable symbol of composite cultural heritage.

Q 53. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Sharavathi Lion-Tailed Macaque Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Sharavathi River Valley, Sagar Taluk, Shivamogga District, Karnataka. It lies within the Western Ghats, which is recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- The sanctuary was formed by merging the previously existing Sharavathi Valley Wildlife Sanctuary, the Aghanashini Lion-Tailed Macaque Conservation Reserve, and adjoining reserve forest blocks. It covers a total area of approximately 431.23 sq. km, which includes the Linganamakki Reservoir spanning about 124 sq. km. It shares its southwestern boundary with the Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary.
- It is the single largest habitat of the endangered Lion-Tailed Macaque (*Macaca silenus*) in the Western Ghats, with an estimated population of approximately 700 individuals. According to the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), only around 2,500 individuals of this species remain in the wild globally.
- The sanctuary recently came into news in the context of the proposed Sharavathi Pumped Storage Project (2,000 MW), to be implemented by the Karnataka Power Corporation Limited, for which the National Board for Wildlife granted in-principle approval in July 2025, drawing significant opposition from environmentalists and local communities.

Q 54. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Dhvani Spandana is an audio based assistive system developed and implemented by the Karnataka State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) to enable visually impaired passengers to identify and board city buses independently without external assistance.
- The initiative was launched on July 14, 2025, at the Mysuru City Bus Stand by Karnataka's Transport Minister R. Ramalinga Reddy. It was initially deployed in 200 city buses in Mysuru, with 125 buses in Bengaluru already fitted with the system prior to the launch.
- The system was developed by the Raised Lines Foundation in collaboration with IIT Delhi, Continental Automotive Components India, and Enable India, and was funded by the German development agency GIZ India under the Green

Urban Mobility Partnership between India and Germany.

- KSRTC subsequently received the National Award for Excellence in Urban Transport 2025 from the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs for this initiative under the category of Best State for Implementing Urban Transport Projects.

Q 55. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The e-Swasthya Dham portal was launched by the Government of Uttarakhand to enable real-time health monitoring of pilgrims undertaking the Char Dham Yatra, which comprises the four sacred shrines of Yamunotri, Gangotri, Kedarnath, and Badrinath.
- The portal was developed in collaboration with the Wadhvani Initiative for Sustainable Healthcare (WISH) and the Hans Foundation. It requires pilgrims to upload their health related data and is integrated with the existing online registration system for the Char Dham Yatra.
- Special emphasis is placed on pilgrims aged 50 and above, and those with conditions such as hypertension, diabetes, or cardiac ailments, given the high altitude and low oxygen levels at the shrine locations. The portal also enables pilgrims to create their Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) number.
- As part of broader health preparedness for the yatra, Uttarakhand deployed 177 ambulances including road, helicopter, and boat ambulances, along with 150 doctors and paramedical staff across the pilgrimage route.

Q 56. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Gau-Tech 2026 was organised from March 20 to 23, 2026, at the Agriculture College Ground, Shivajinagar, Pune, by the Global Confederation of Cow Based Industries (GCCI) in association with the Maharashtra Goseva Commission.
- The exhibition aimed to promote cow based agriculture, bio-energy, organic farming, and Panchgavya based industries, with over 300 stalls, more than 10 thematic conferences, and an expected footfall of over five lakh visitors.
- The event sought to shift gaushalas from donation based dependency to financial self-reliance by integrating traditional cow based practices with modern technology and entrepreneurship, in alignment with the vision of Atmanirbhar Bharat.

Q 57. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan is a water conservation initiative of the Government of Madhya Pradesh, first launched on March 30, 2025, from the banks of the Kshipra River in Ujjain by Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav. Its third phase was inaugurated on March 19, 2026, at Indore with an outlay of Rs. 2,500 crore.
- The campaign aims to conserve and revive water bodies including rivers, ponds, wells, and stepwells across all 55 districts of the state, with targets covering construction of over 10,000 check dams, groundwater recharge structures, and pond rejuvenation.
- The initiative is inspired by the Prime Minister's Catch the Rain campaign and Mission LiFE, and seeks to promote public participation, rainwater harvesting, and water reuse across both urban and rural areas of the state.

Q 58. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Ayush Suraksha Portal was launched on May 30, 2025, by the Ministry of Ayush under Union Minister of State Prataprao Jadhav. It serves as a centralised IT platform to report and monitor misleading advertisements and adverse drug reactions (ADRs) related to Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, and Homoeopathy (ASU&H) medicines.
- The portal was developed in compliance with the Supreme Court's order dated July 30, 2024, which directed the Union government to establish a centralised dashboard for tracking misleading advertisements and ADRs before June 2025.
- It integrates data from State Licensing Authorities, national pharmacovigilance centres, and regulatory bodies including CDSCO, CCPA, and the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, enabling real-time tracking and coordinated regulatory action.

Q 59. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Shaheen Falcon (*Falco peregrinus peregrinator*), also known as the Indian Peregrine Falcon, is a non-migratory subspecies of the Peregrine Falcon endemic to the Indian subcontinent, found across Pakistan, India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and parts of Southeast Asia. It is classified as Vulnerable on the IUCN Red List.

- It inhabits rocky cliffs and hilly terrain and is known for being one of the fastest birds, capable of exceeding 320 km/h in a dive. Its estimated wild population stands at approximately 100 breeding pairs.
- The parent species, the Peregrine Falcon (*Falco peregrinus*), is listed as Least Concern by the IUCN, which is a common point of confusion in examination questions.

Q 60. Ans. C

Explanation:

- World Meteorological Day is observed every year on March 23 to commemorate the establishment of the World Meteorological Organization (WMO), which came into existence on March 23, 1950. The WMO is a specialised agency of the United Nations responsible for international cooperation in meteorology, climatology, hydrology, and related geophysical sciences.
- The theme for World Meteorological Day 2025 was "Closing the Early Warning Gap," emphasising the need to expand early warning systems for weather, climate, and water related hazards to protect vulnerable populations globally.
- March 22 is observed as World Water Day, and March 21 as World Forestry Day, which are common distractors in examination questions involving this date.

Q 61. Ans. A

Explanation:

- William Dalrymple, a renowned Scottish historian, was awarded the 2026 Mark Lynton History Prize for his book *The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World*. The jury commended the work for combining literary grace, commitment to serious research, and social concern.
- The book argues that ancient India, between 250 BCE and 1200 CE, was the central driver of global exchange through a maritime and overland network termed the "Golden Road," challenging the traditional historiographical emphasis on China's Silk Road. It documents the spread of Buddhism, Indian numerals, mathematics, and astronomy across Asia and the Mediterranean.
- The Mark Lynton History Prize is an annual USD 10,000 award administered jointly by the Nieman Foundation for Journalism and the Columbia University School of Journalism as part of the J. Anthony Lukas Book Prize. It honours works of history that best combine intellectual distinction with felicity of expression.

Q 62. Ans. C

Explanation:

- According to the National Import Export Record for Yearly Analysis of Trade (NIRYAT) data, Tamil Nadu emerged as India's leading textile-exporting state in 2024-25, with exports valued at USD 7,997.17 million out of India's total textile exports of USD 36,610 million, registering a 29.12 per cent growth over four years.
- Gujarat ranked second with exports of USD 5,749 million, followed by Maharashtra. This data was also corroborated in a written reply by the Minister of Textiles in the Lok Sabha on March 24, 2026.

Q 63. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Kailash Satyarthi is the author of the book *Karuna: The Power of Compassion*. The work was published in 2026 in partnership with HarperCollins and serves as a manifesto for the Satyarthi Movement for Global Compassion.
- The Nobel Peace Laureate outlines how compassion can act as a transformative force in public life, governance, and the global economic order to address systemic inequality and conflict.

Q 64. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The 20th G20 Summit 2025 was hosted in Johannesburg under the presidency of South Africa. The summit adopted the theme "Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability", reflecting priorities such as inclusive growth, climate action, sustainable development and cooperation among developing and developed economies. The theme also highlighted the importance of multilateralism and Global South concerns in global governance discussions.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The 2025 summit marked the first-ever G20 Summit hosted on the African continent. This was considered historically significant because it enhanced Africa's representation in global economic governance. South Africa's presidency came soon after the African Union was admitted as a permanent member of the G20 during the 2023 New Delhi Summit. The event symbolised increasing recognition of Africa's strategic and economic importance in world affairs.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The IBSA Dialogue Forum Leaders' Meeting was also held in Johannesburg

alongside the G20-related engagements. Leaders of India, Brazil and South Africa discussed cooperation on South-South collaboration, global governance reforms, sustainable development and issues concerning developing countries. The IBSA grouping is an important trilateral forum representing major democracies of the Global South.

Q 65. Ans. B

Explanation:

- According to the Global Risks Report 2026 published by the World Economic Forum, the Indus River Basin was identified as a potential near-term bilateral flashpoint involving India and Pakistan. The report highlighted growing concerns over water security, climate stress and transboundary river management in the region.

Q 66. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Him Yodha contingent featured Bactrian camels used in high-altitude logistics and operational support in Ladakh and other Himalayan regions. Official and media descriptions mention Bactrian camels from the Galwan and Nubra regions being showcased during the Republic Day parade.
- The “Sindoor Formation” was part of the Republic Day flypast conducted by the Indian Air Force and symbolised operational readiness linked to Operation Sindoor. It included aircraft such as Rafale, MiG-29, Su-30 and Jaguar.
- The Ministry of Culture will present the performance on the theme ‘Vande Mataram - The Eternal Resonance of Bharat’, marking the 150th anniversary of the National Song.

Q 67. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **National SC/ST Hub (NSSH) → National Small Industries Corporation Limited (NSIC)**
 - ✓ The National SC/ST Hub scheme is implemented by National Small Industries Corporation under the Ministry of MSME. The scheme aims to support SC/ST entrepreneurs by providing market access, capacity building and participation in public procurement.
- **Dulhasti Stage-II Hydropower Project → Jammu & Kashmir (Chenab River)**
 - ✓ The Dulhasti Stage-II Hydropower Project is proposed in Jammu and Kashmir on the

Chenab River system. The project is part of India’s hydroelectric expansion in the Himalayan region and is associated with NHPC’s power generation initiatives.

● **Palmnaro Electro-Optical Payload Facility → Sanand, Gujarat**

- ✓ The Palmnaro Electro-Optical Payload Facility was established at Sanand. The facility is linked with advanced defence and aerospace manufacturing, especially electro-optical systems used in surveillance and targeting technologies.

● **Institutional Environmental Clearance → Environment Ministry’s Expert Appraisal Committee**

- ✓ Institutional environmental clearances are processed through the Expert Appraisal Committee under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change. The committee evaluates projects for environmental impact before granting statutory clearances.

Q 68. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** Under the Nutrient-Based Subsidy Scheme, subsidies are provided to phosphatic and potassic (P&K) fertilisers on the basis of nutrient content. However, urea is not included in this per-nutrient subsidy framework and continues to operate under a separate subsidy mechanism.
- **Reason (R) is also true:** Urea remains under direct price control of the Union Government. Its Maximum Retail Price (MRP) is fixed statutorily by the government to ensure affordable availability to farmers across the country. Fertiliser companies are compensated separately through the urea subsidy regime.
- **Why (R) correctly explains (A):** The very reason urea is excluded from the NBS framework is that it follows a completely different pricing and subsidy structure. Unlike P&K fertilisers, where market pricing with nutrient-linked subsidy is allowed, urea prices are centrally fixed and tightly regulated by the government.

Q 69. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Mamady Doumbouya → President of Guinea**
 - ✓ Mamady Doumbouya is a military officer who led the 2021 coup in Guinea that removed

President Alpha Condé from power. He later became the transitional President of Guinea and has remained a prominent figure in the country's political transition.

- **Delcy Rodríguez → Interim President of Venezuela**
 - ✓ Delcy Rodríguez is a senior Venezuelan political leader who has served in important positions such as Vice President and Foreign Minister.
- **Shaya Mohsen Zindani → Prime Minister of Yemen**
 - ✓ Shaya Mohsen Zindani was appointed as the Prime Minister of Yemen under the internationally recognised government. His appointment came at a time when Yemen continues to face prolonged civil conflict, humanitarian crises, and political instability.
- **Yoweri Museveni → Re-elected as the 7th President of Uganda**
 - ✓ Yoweri Museveni is one of Africa's longest-serving leaders and has ruled Uganda since 1986. He was re-elected as Uganda's 7th President, further extending his decades-long political dominance in the country.

Q 70. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Assam became the first Indian state to constitute the 8th Pay Commission for state government employees. The commission was formed to review and recommend revisions in salaries, pensions, and allowances of government staff.

Q 71. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In a significant milestone for sustainable community development, Keyi Panyor district in Arunachal Pradesh was officially declared India's very first "Bio-Happy District." This initiative focuses on harmonising local tribal livelihoods with biodiversity conservation, promoting organic farming, protecting indigenous forest patches, and establishing a micro-economy built on ecological health and community well-being.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The diamond hub of Gujarat, Surat, has achieved the distinction of becoming India's first slum-free city. This milestone was accomplished under an intensive, targeted urban housing initiative and slum rehabilitation program, which successfully integrated low-income settlements into formal, well-built housing units equipped with regularised civic amenities, piped water, and proper sanitation infrastructure.

Q 72. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Department of Posts (India Post), under the Ministry of Communications, rolled out a nationwide initiative to transform traditional campus-based post offices into "Gen-Z" or Next-Generation (N-Gen) technology-enabled service hubs.
- **Bihar's First Hub:** The first Gen-Z Post Office in the state of Bihar was launched at the IIT Patna campus. Designed in close coordination with the institute's students, this facility breaks away from traditional administrative layouts to mirror a vibrant, youth-centric social hangout.

Q 73. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Kajra Solar Power Plant is being actively developed by the Bihar State Power Generation Company Limited (BSPGCL) in the Lakhisarai district of Bihar. It stands out as one of India's prominent grid-connected solar-plus-storage projects because it features large-scale integrated Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS). This system allows the plant to store excess generation and supply uninterrupted clean power for 4–5 hours during peak evening hours or periods of low sunlight.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Upon full completion of all its phases (targeted for January 2027), the total planned solar generation capacity will be 301 MW (comprising a 185 MW Phase-I and a 116 MW Phase-II), not exceeding 500 MW. The total battery energy storage component will reach a capacity of 495 Megawatt-hours (MWh).

Q 74. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** Bihar became the first state in India to implement the concept of "Trial in Absentia" under the new criminal justice framework introduced through the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). This reflects an effort to prevent misuse of the judicial process by absconding accused persons and to ensure faster disposal of serious criminal cases.
- **Reason (R) is also true:** Section 356 of the BNSS provides legal backing for conducting trials in the absence of an accused who has been declared absconding or a proclaimed offender in certain serious offences, subject to procedural safeguards.

- **Why(R) correctly explains(A):** The implementation of “Trial in Absentia” in Bihar is directly enabled by Section 356 of the BNSS. Since this section explicitly allows courts to proceed with trials even when the accused is absent, it forms the legal basis for Bihar’s implementation

Q 75. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Bhikhari Thakur, widely referred to as the “Shakespeare of Bhojpuri,” is the legendary playwright, lyricist, and actor who created Bidesiya. This iconic folk theater style poignantly captures the social and emotional struggles of migration and family separation in rural Bihar.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The Mahabodhi Temple complex in Bodh Gaya, Bihar—a UNESCO World Heritage Site—served as the sacred venue for the 20th International Tripitaka Chanting Ceremony. The mega event brings together thousands of Buddhist monks, scholars, and devotees from multiple nations to chant the sacred Buddhist scriptures (Tripitakas) for global peace.
- **Pair 3 is incorrectly matched:** Tikuli Art is a traditional craft from the Patna region, not an embroidery form of the Mithila region. Its origins trace back over 500 years, featuring intricate designs painted onto glass sheets or wooden bases using gold leaf and enamel colors. (The famous traditional embroidery form associated with Mithila is Sujini craft or Kashida).
- **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** Under the National Supercomputing Mission (NSM), Param Rudra represents the advanced high-performance computing system established in premier scientific centers, marking a crucial step forward in boosting regional research capacity in climate modeling, big data analytics, and computational science.

Q 76. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Suryastra is indeed India’s first indigenous universal multi-calibre rocket launcher (MCRL) system. It is engineered with a modular, highly flexible platform designed to seamlessly fire rockets of different diameters (calibres) from a single launcher without requiring intensive hardware changes.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The system is designed for long-range precision surface-to-surface strikes,

with a verified capability to hit targets at ranges of 150 km and 300 km. Recent trials at Chandipur confirmed its deep-strike accuracy

- **Statement 3 is correct:** The system was developed by Pune-based private firm NIBE Limited in strategic collaboration with Israel’s Elbit Systems. It is based on Elbit’s PULS (Precise & Universal Launching System) technology, adapted for domestic production under the ‘Aatmanirbhar Bharat’

Q 77. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Skilling for AI Readiness (SOAR) program in India represents a strategic initiative by the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) to integrate artificial intelligence competencies into India’s educational framework.
- The SOAR initiative prioritises cultivating AI literacy among school students and educators. By introducing foundational AI concepts, such as machine learning (ML) basics and ethical AI use, the program aims to spark curiosity and aspiration among young learners, preparing them for a tech-driven future. For educators, SOAR provides specialised training to incorporate AI modules into existing curricula, ensuring effective delivery and alignment with industry needs.

Q 78. Ans. B

Explanation:

- PANKHUDI portal is developed as a single-window digital platform that brings together individuals, Non-Resident Indians (NRIs), Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs), Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) contributors, corporate entities, and government agencies working in the domain of women and child development. The portal streamlines and unifies voluntary and institutional contributions across key thematic areas including nutrition, health, Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE), child welfare, protection and rehabilitation, and women’s safety and empowerment.

Q 79. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India has recently concluded a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with New Zealand, which provides 100% duty-free access for all Indian exports, covering all tariff lines.
- This agreement is expected to significantly enhance

India's export competitiveness, especially in labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, apparel, leather, footwear, gems and jewellery, engineering goods, and processed foods, thereby also boosting MSMEs and employment generation.

Q 80. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** ICGS Samudra Pratap is the first indigenously designed and built Pollution Control Vessel (PCV) of the Indian Coast Guard. It features over 60% indigenous content, reinforcing self-reliance under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative. It is also the largest ship in the Coast Guard's fleet to date.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The vessel has been constructed by Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL). Its primary role is to contain, recover, and mitigate marine pollution, specifically oil spillages, within India's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) and beyond. It is equipped with advanced systems to tackle oil slicks, including side-sweeping arms, floating booms, high-capacity skimmers, and an onboard pollution control laboratory.

Q 81. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Bihar recently approved a pilot project for installing "Grain ATMs" (Annapurta machines) in Patna under the Public Distribution System (PDS). With this, Bihar became the fourth state in the country to adopt the initiative aimed at automating ration distribution, improving transparency, and reducing leakages in the system.
- Grain ATMs are automated dispensing machines developed with support from the World Food Programme. Beneficiaries can obtain wheat and rice through Aadhaar-based biometric authentication, similar to withdrawing cash from a bank ATM.

Q 82. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Bharat Singh Bharti is associated with the preservation and promotion of Bhojpuri folk music traditions, contributing significantly to the safeguarding of Bihar's regional cultural heritage and oral traditions through performances and cultural outreach.
- Dr. Gopalji Trivedi is associated with contributions in the field of science, engineering, and agricultural education, particularly focusing on innovation and

capacity building in rural and technical education systems.

- Vishwa Bandhu is linked with the promotion of Madhubani painting traditions, contributing to its global recognition through exhibitions and efforts to preserve this classical folk art form of Bihar.
- Bindeshwar Pathak (posthumously referenced) is widely recognised for his contributions to social reform, sanitation movement, and public welfare initiatives, particularly through grassroots-level sanitation and dignity-of-labour campaigns.

Q 83. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Patna High Court recently set a record when Justice Rajeev Ranjan Prasad Mishra heard 510 cases in a single day, primarily related to Bihar's prohibition law. Out of these, lawyers were present in 475 cases, and orders were passed promptly, reflecting an effort to reduce the backlog of pending cases and speed up judicial delivery.
- The achievement highlighted the increasing use of efficient case management and coordinated preparation by prosecutors and court officials in handling a large number of matters within a limited time.

Q 84. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The SAARG Committee, chaired by Shri Narayan Ramachandran, has been constituted in the context of reforms related to the National Pension System (NPS). Its primary role is to review and provide recommendations on investment norms, asset allocation framework, and portfolio management guidelines to enhance long-term returns while maintaining risk stability for subscribers.
- This initiative is part of ongoing reforms under the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) to make the NPS more efficient, transparent, and sustainable for subscribers.

Q 85. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Economic Survey 2025–26 projected India's real GDP growth for FY26 at around 7.4%. The Survey highlighted that strong domestic demand, improving manufacturing activity, resilient services growth, public infrastructure investment, and stable financial conditions are expected to support economic

expansion. India continued to remain among the fastest-growing major economies globally.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Economic Survey did not report headline CPI inflation at 6.8% for April–December 2025. Instead, retail inflation remained comparatively moderate during the period due to easing food prices, improved supply-side management, and monetary policy measures undertaken by the Reserve Bank of India.

Q 86. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The United Arab Emirates recently approved USDU, the country's first USD-backed stablecoin registered under the Central Bank's Payment Token Services Regulation (PTSR) framework. The stablecoin has been issued by Universal Digital, a fintech firm regulated by the Financial Services Regulatory Authority (FSRA) of Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM).
- USDU is fully backed 1:1 by U.S. dollar reserves held with UAE-based banks such as Emirates NBD and Mashreq. The approval marks a significant step in the UAE's efforts to establish a regulated digital asset ecosystem and strengthen its position as a global fintech and crypto hub.

Q 87. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Sixteenth Finance Commission has recommended retaining the states' share in the divisible pool of central taxes at 41%, the same level recommended earlier by the 15th Finance Commission. The reduction from the earlier 42% had been made after the reorganization of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir into Union Territories, and the 16th Finance Commission has continued this arrangement.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The 16th Finance Commission introduced a new criterion of "Contribution to GDP" with a weightage of 10% in the horizontal devolution formula. This parameter aims to recognize states' contribution to national economic growth and improve efficiency-oriented fiscal federalism. The earlier "Tax and Fiscal Effort" criterion has been removed.

Q 88. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Bihar government recently approved the Bihar Semiconductor Policy 2026 with the objective of

transforming the state into a major semiconductor and electronics manufacturing hub in eastern India. Under the policy, the state has set an investment target of around ₹25,000 crore in the semiconductor and electronics sector.

- The government also plans to establish major semiconductor units such as fabrication plants (fabs) and ATMP (Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging) facilities.

Q 89. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India secured the 3rd position in Stanford University's latest Global AI Vibrancy Index, reflecting the country's rapid progress in artificial intelligence research, talent development, infrastructure, policy support, and innovation ecosystem. India moved up significantly in the rankings, surpassing countries such as the United Kingdom, South Korea, Singapore, and Japan.
- The rankings are part of Stanford University's Global AI Vibrancy Tool, which evaluates countries across multiple pillars including research and development, responsible AI, economy, talent, governance, public opinion, and infrastructure. The United States and China occupied the top two positions, while India emerged as the third most vibrant AI ecosystem globally.

Q 90. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Puga Valley Geothermal Energy Project is being developed in the Union Territory of Ladakh and is regarded as India's first major geothermal power project intended for operational electricity generation. The Puga Valley, located in the Changthang region, is known for its high geothermal potential due to the presence of hot springs and geothermal reservoirs. The project aims to provide clean and sustainable energy in the cold desert region while reducing dependence on fossil fuels.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The project is being implemented by the ONGC Energy Centre, which functions as the research and development wing of Oil and Natural Gas Corporation. The ONGC Energy Centre has been conducting geothermal exploration and feasibility studies in the Puga Valley region to harness geothermal energy for power generation and direct heating applications.

Q 91. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Bio-RIDE (Biotechnology Research, Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development) scheme is a major initiative of the Department of Biotechnology under the Ministry of Science and Technology. It aims to strengthen India's biotechnology ecosystem by promoting advanced research, innovation, bio-entrepreneurship, and industrial-scale bio-manufacturing.
- The scheme integrates and streamlines various biotechnology programmes to support areas such as:
 - ✓ biopharmaceuticals
 - ✓ synthetic biology
 - ✓ bio-agriculture
 - ✓ precision medicine
 - ✓ climate-resilient biotechnology
 - ✓ and startup-driven innovation

Q 92. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- AgriStack is a major digital public infrastructure initiative of the Government of India aimed at building a unified and interoperable digital ecosystem for the agriculture sector. It seeks to integrate:
 - ✓ farmer databases,
 - ✓ digitised land records,
 - ✓ crop-sown information,
 - ✓ weather and satellite data,
 - ✓ access to agricultural services such as credit, insurance, advisory support, and input delivery.
- The initiative is designed to improve efficiency, transparency, and targeted delivery of government schemes while enabling data-driven agricultural planning and precision farming support. It also forms a key component of the broader Digital Agriculture Mission of the Union Government.

Q 93. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Vijender Singh, India's Olympic medal-winning boxer, was recently inducted as a member of the Asian Boxing Council. His appointment reflects India's growing influence in international boxing administration and governance.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** Tarique Rahman became the Prime

Minister of Bangladesh following the electoral victory of the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP). Earlier, he had served as the acting chairman of the BNP and remained a key political figure in Bangladeshi politics.

- **Pair 3 is correct:** Mia Mottley is the serving Prime Minister of Barbados. She is internationally recognised for her advocacy on climate finance, small island developing states (SIDS), and global financial reforms. She has also emerged as a prominent voice in discussions on climate justice and sustainable development.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** Jose Maria Balcasar was appointed Interim President of Peru amid political instability and constitutional transition in the country. Peru has witnessed repeated leadership changes in recent years due to parliamentary crises and executive-legislative conflicts.

Q 94. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Agnikul Cosmos has partnered with ISRO to establish India's first privately developed and commercially operated satellite launch pad and mission control centre at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota.
- The launch infrastructure was developed for Agnikul's small satellite launch vehicle Agnibaan, a customizable two-stage rocket designed to carry payloads to low Earth orbit. The launch pad is significant because it represents a major step in India's space-sector reforms that allow private companies to participate in end-to-end space operations, including launch infrastructure development.

Q 95. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) is a climate-related trade policy introduced by the European Union as part of its broader European Green Deal. CBAM aims to impose a carbon price on certain imported goods entering the EU to prevent "carbon leakage," where industries shift production to countries with less stringent climate regulations.
- Under the mechanism, importers of products such as steel, cement, aluminium, fertilizers, electricity, and hydrogen are required to report and eventually pay for the embedded carbon emissions associated with these goods.

Q 96. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship was organised in Roorkee, Uttarakhand with the objective of promoting inclusive sports and empowering persons with disabilities through national-level competitive exposure. The event highlighted the importance of equal sporting opportunities and strengthening India's para-sports ecosystem.
- The objective of National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship is Promotion of inclusive sports, empowerment of persons with disabilities, and national-level competitive exposure

Q 97. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The FIDE Freestyle Chess World Championship 2026 was held in Weissenhaus, Germany, a venue that has increasingly become associated with elite freestyle chess events.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Magnus Carlsen won the championship title by defeating Fabiano Caruana in the final. Carlsen is widely regarded as one of the greatest chess players in history and has dominated multiple formats including classical, rapid, blitz, and freestyle chess.

Q 98. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Military Quantum Mission Policy Framework was launched by Anil Chauhan to guide the integration of advanced quantum technologies into India's armed forces. The framework serves as a comprehensive roadmap for incorporating the four major pillars of quantum technology:
 - ✓ Quantum Communication
 - ✓ Quantum Computing
 - ✓ Quantum Sensing & Metrology
 - ✓ and Quantum Materials & Devices into the Tri-Services structure of the Indian military.
- The initiative aims to strengthen future battlefield preparedness, enhance secure military communication systems, improve precision sensing capabilities, and help India achieve technological dominance in emerging defence technologies.

Q 99. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Pilloo AI is a next-generation voice-based billing

and accounting agent launched by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to support small and medium enterprises (SMEs). The platform is designed to simplify bookkeeping, invoice generation, and accounting operations through AI-enabled voice interaction technology.

- The initiative seeks to improve digital accessibility for small entrepreneurs, particularly those with limited technical knowledge, by enabling business management in a simple and user-friendly manner, including support for regional language.

Q 100. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- World Wetlands Day is observed every year on 2 February to commemorate the adoption of the Ramsar Convention on Wetlands in 1971 at Ramsar, Iran. The day aims to spread awareness about the ecological importance of wetlands in biodiversity conservation, climate regulation, and water security.
- World Cancer Day is observed annually on 4 February under the leadership of the Union for International Cancer Control (UICC). It promotes awareness regarding cancer prevention, early detection, treatment, and equitable healthcare access.
- National Voters' Day is celebrated in India on 25 January to mark the foundation day of the Election Commission of India, which was established in 1950. The objective is to encourage informed and active participation in the democratic electoral process, especially among first-time voters.
- International Epilepsy Day 2026 was observed on 9 February. It is a global healthcare awareness campaign aimed at reducing stigma associated with epilepsy and promoting better treatment, support systems, and public understanding of neurological disorders.

Q 101. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- TranslateGemma is a new open-source, high-quality translation model launched by Google and built on the Gemma 3 architecture. It supports translation across 55 languages and is designed to improve multilingual AI accessibility, language translation quality, and open-source AI innovation. The model reflects Google's growing focus on lightweight and developer-friendly generative AI systems.

Q 102. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Agni-III is an intermediate-range ballistic missile (IRBM) developed by India as part of its strategic nuclear deterrence programme. It is a nuclear-capable surface-to-surface missile with a strike range of more than 3,000 km and can carry a payload of around 1.5 tonnes. It was recently test-fired successfully from the Integrated Test Range at Chandipur, Odisha.

Q 103. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Om Birla recently launched the National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) at the Bihar Legislative Assembly in Patna during the Assembly's 105th foundation day celebrations. The launch marked an important step toward digital transformation of legislative institutions in India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** NeVA is a digital governance initiative aimed at making State Legislatures and Union Territory Assemblies fully paperless by digitising legislative processes such as notices, questions, bills, committee reports, agenda circulation, and House proceedings. The initiative is part of the broader Digital India framework for improving transparency, efficiency, and accessibility in legislative functioning.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** NeVA is implemented by the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs and is not monitored or regulated by the Election Commission of India. The Election Commission has no role in legislative record management under the NeVA framework.

Q 104. Ans. B

Explanation:

- NITI Aayog has launched "Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0" as a focused nationwide campaign to improve the delivery of essential public services in Aspirational Districts and Aspirational Blocks. The initiative aims to achieve saturation in critical development indicators related to sectors such as health, nutrition, education, and basic welfare services.

Q 105. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Pangolins are unique mammals often called "scaly anteaters" because

they are the only mammals in the world completely covered with hard, overlapping keratin scales that provide protection from predators.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Pangolins are primarily nocturnal and insectivorous mammals found in parts of Asia and Africa. They play an important ecological role as natural pest controllers by feeding on ants and termites.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Indian Pangolin is listed as Endangered, not Critically Endangered, on the IUCN Red List. Pangolins are also protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Q 106. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Recently, the World Economic Forum Annual Meeting 2026 was held at Davos-Klosters, Switzerland with the theme "A Spirit of Dialogue". The meeting is organised by the World Economic Forum and aims to promote global dialogue and multistakeholder cooperation to address key global challenges in a fragmented world. The focus is on issues such as geopolitical tensions, economic growth, technological transformation, and sustainable development.

Q 107. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Para Throwball National Federation Cup 2026 was held at Singhania University, Jhunjhunu (Rajasthan) and featured competitions in both men's and women's categories.
- In the women's category, the Jharkhand team secured the gold medal, while the host state Rajasthan finished as the runner-up. In the men's category, the Andhra Pradesh team won the gold medal, while Telangana secured the silver medal.
- This performance highlights the growing participation and competitive performance of states in para-sports events, reflecting the broader push for inclusivity and promotion of sports among persons with disabilities in India.

Q 108. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** India participated for the first time as a partner country in Gulfood 2026, marking a significant milestone in its participation in one of the world's largest food and beverage sourcing events. This reflects India's growing

global presence in agri-export markets and food processing trade.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** India's participation was led by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. APEDA is responsible for promoting exports of agricultural and processed food products and regularly represents India in major international food trade fairs.

Q 109. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The World Governments Summit 2026 was held in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, which serves as a global platform for discussing governance innovations, future-ready policy frameworks, and international cooperation among governments.
- The summit is hosted annually by the UAE government and brings together heads of state, policymakers, international organisations, and experts to deliberate on themes such as digital transformation, AI governance, sustainable development, and efficient public service delivery.
- The 2026 edition focused on the theme "Shaping Future Governments", emphasising innovation-driven and citizen-centric governance models.

Q 110. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The DOSTI Exercise (DOSTI-17) is a trilateral maritime security drill conducted among the Coast Guards of India, Sri Lanka, and the Maldives. The 17th edition was recently held in Malé, Maldives (17–19 January 2026).
- The exercise aims to strengthen regional maritime security cooperation, enhance interoperability, and improve coordination among the participating countries in areas such as search and rescue operations, maritime law enforcement, and disaster response.

Q 111. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Muna Island is located in Indonesia and has recently been in the news due to the discovery of ancient cave paintings. Archaeologists have estimated these artworks to be up to 67,800 years old, making them among the oldest known examples of human artistic expression.
- This discovery is significant as it provides important

evidence of early human cognitive development and symbolic behaviour in Southeast Asia, particularly in the Indonesian archipelago, which is known for several important prehistoric cave art sites.

Q 112. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Chhari-Dhand Wetland has recently been declared a Ramsar Site, which designates it as a wetland of international importance under the Ramsar Convention. With this addition, it becomes the fifth Ramsar site in Gujarat after Nal Sarovar, Thol, Khijadiya and Vadhvana.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The wetland is located in Kutch district of Gujarat at the ecological boundary of the Banni grasslands and the Rann of Kutch salt flats. This location creates a unique transitional ecosystem where desert, grassland, and wetland environments converge. As a result, it supports rich biodiversity, including a large number of migratory and resident bird species as well as desert-adapted wildlife.

Q 113. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The SATYA Portal is a Lab Automation Portal developed under the STQC Directorate, which functions under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). It is aimed at digitising and automating laboratory testing and certification processes.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The portal integrates testing, certification, and quality assurance services into a single unified digital platform. This helps improve transparency, efficiency, and speed of service delivery for citizens, industry, startups, MSMEs, and government departments.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The SATYA Portal is not linked to GSTN or indirect tax compliance systems. It is focused exclusively on certification, testing, and quality assurance services, and has no role in tax filing or GST-related processes.

Q 114. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Jeevan Raksha Padak Series of Awards are conferred by the President of India on individuals for meritorious acts of human nature involving the saving of human life.
- The awards are given in three categories: Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak (highest), Uttam Jeevan

Raksha Padak, and Jeevan Raksha Padak. They can be awarded to persons from all walks of life and may also be conferred posthumously.

Q 115. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Granth Kutir is a library of classical languages located in Rashtrapati Bhavan. The term “Granth Kutir” means a house of books and knowledge. Granth Kutir symbolizes India’s deep respect for learning, scholarship, and intellectual heritage.
- Granth Kutir represents all classical languages of India—Assamese, Bengali, Sanskrit, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Odia, Tamil, and Telugu—each of which carries a continuous literary tradition spanning over a millennium.

Q 116. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Cyclone Montha along with unseasonal rainfall, caused extensive crop damage across 132 districts of Bihar. After a detailed survey covering 53 39 blocks and 493 397 panchayats, the state government announced an agricultural relief package providing direct input subsidies to affected farmers. Compensation ranges from ₹8,500 for rain-fed land to ₹22,500 per hectare for multi-crop land to aid recovery before the next sowing season.

Q 117. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Chief Minister Fellowship Scheme is a two-year programme implemented by the General Administration Department (GAD) and IIM, Bodh Gaya. It focuses on innovation, accountability, and high-quality input in administrative decisions. Upon completion, IIM Bodh Gaya awards a certificate of Public Policy and Good Governance. The collaboration is being implemented under the Bihar Administrative Reforms Mission Society.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme is not an unemployment allowance programme. It is a policy and governance fellowship aimed at engaging young professionals in administrative and developmental work. The fellowship is restricted exclusively to the domiciled people of Bihar. Furthermore, the stipend is not uniform; fellows are categorized to receive varying monthly stipends of ₹1.5 lakh, ₹1.25 lakh, ₹1 lakh, and ₹80,000.

Q 118. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The nodal agency for the Satellite Township Scheme is the Bihar Urban Development and Housing Department, not the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. The scheme is being implemented by the Bihar government to promote planned urban expansion in the state.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The scheme follows a land pooling model instead of compulsory land acquisition. Under this arrangement, landowners contribute land for development and receive around 55% of the developed plots back after infrastructure creation. This model is intended to reduce disputes and encourage public participation in urban development projects.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The scheme targets all nine divisional headquarters of Bihar — Patna, Chapra, Gaya, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Bhagalpur, Munger, Purnia, and Saharsa — along with two special townships at Sonpur and Sitamarhi Sitapuram. Its objective is to reduce congestion and population pressure in existing cities by developing modern satellite townships with better infrastructure, economic hubs, and employment opportunities.

Q 119. Ans. D

Explanation:

- According to the Drug and Vaccine Distribution Management System (DVDMS) portal of the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Bihar secured the top rank in the country for the 18th eleventh consecutive month (starting from September 2024) in the supply, distribution, and utilisation of free medicines in government hospitals and health centres.
- The ranking, conducted among 24 states, is based on 11 performance parameters related to medicine distribution and inventory management under the DVDMS framework. Bihar was recognised for the effective implementation of the system, while Rajasthan and Punjab secured the second and third positions respectively.

Q 120. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The State cabinet approved the creation of three new departments to ensure better and effective implementation of its schemes and policies in order

to achieve the government's target of providing jobs and employment opportunities to one crore youth in the next five years. The three newly created departments are:

- ✓ **Department of Youth, Employment and Skills Development:** To give entrepreneurial opportunities to a large number of youth in the next 5 years.
- ✓ **Higher Education Department:** To bring about qualitative improvement, promote research and innovation, develop technical and vocational education and provide employment-oriented education.
- ✓ **Civil Aviation Department:** To accelerate the construction projects of several new airports in the region, improve the industrial environment, and create employment opportunities...

Q 121. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Bihar government has approved a proposal to declare Gaya Ji and Munger as Civil Defence Districts in view of their strategic importance and significance in internal security.
- At present, Bihar has 28 Civil Defence districts, and all of them have been notified primarily due to their vulnerability to floods. Addition of these 2 districts will increase the number of Civil Defence districts in Bihar to 30.
 - ✓ **Gaya:** The district includes Bodh Gaya, a major international religious centre that attracts huge crowds during the Pitru Paksha Mela, necessitating enhanced crowd management and safety measures.
 - ✓ **Munger:** The district houses key industrial units such as the Jamalpur Locomotive Workshop, a British-era gun factory, and an ITC unit, making it strategically sensitive during hostile or wartime situations.

Q 122. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Proposed by the Department of Posts under the Ministry of Communications, DHRUVA initiative aims to create an interoperable digital addressing framework based on the Address-as-a-Service (AaaS) model. It seeks to standardise and simplify address management for governance, service delivery, logistics, and emergency response systems.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The initiative does not

mandate automatic or non-consensual sharing of user addresses across government databases. It emphasises user consent, privacy protection, and secure data-sharing mechanisms while enabling interoperability among different platforms and agencies.

Q 123. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** World Fisheries Day 2025 was celebrated with the theme "India's Blue Transformation: Strengthening Value Addition in Seafood Exports." The observance highlighted sustainable fisheries, livelihood generation, seafood exports, and the expansion of the Blue Economy. The event also reflected India's growing international engagement, with participation from delegations of 27 countries.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** India is not the largest fish-producing country in the world. It is currently the second-largest fish producer globally and also one of the leading shrimp-producing countries. The fisheries sector has emerged as an important contributor to food security, exports, employment, and rural livelihoods.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** India's fish production has more than doubled from about 96 lakh tonnes in 2013–14 to nearly 195 lakh tonnes in 2024–25. This growth has been supported by policy reforms, infrastructure expansion, and government schemes aimed at strengthening fisheries and aquaculture.

Q 124. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Meat Production — 4th Rank**
 - ✓ India ranks 4th globally in meat production. Meat production in 2024–25 was estimated at 10.50 million tonnes, registering a growth of 2.46% over the previous year. The leading meat-producing states are West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, and Telangana.
- **Wool Production — 9th Rank**
 - ✓ India ranks 9th in the world in wool production. Wool production during 2024–25 was estimated at 34.57 million kg, showing a growth of 2.63% over the previous year.
- **Milk Production — 1st Rank**
 - ✓ India continues to be the largest milk producer in the world with an estimated production of 247.87 million tonnes in 2024–25, compared

to 239.30 million tonnes in 2023–24. Per capita milk availability increased from 319 gm/day in 2014–15 to 485 gm/day in 2024–25. Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, and Maharashtra are the leading milk-producing states.

● **Egg Production — 2nd Rank**

- ✓ India ranks 2nd globally in egg production, with an estimated production of 149.11 billion eggs in 2024–25. Per capita egg availability increased from 62 eggs per year in 2014–15 to 106 eggs per year in 2024–25. Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, West Bengal, and Karnataka are among the leading egg-producing states.

Q 125. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The newly approved scheme for Manufacturing Sintered Rare Earth Permanent (REPM) Magnets aims to establish an integrated domestic manufacturing capacity of about 6,000 metric tonnes per annum (MTPA). The scheme proposes selection through a global competitive bidding process to promote large-scale and technologically advanced production in India. The initiative is important for strengthening supply chains in sectors such as electric vehicles, electronics, renewable energy, and defence.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme is not limited to a total duration of five years. Its overall timeline includes separate gestation and incentive-disbursement phases extending beyond five years (a 2-year gestation period for setting up the facilities, followed by a 5-year incentive disbursement phase) to support long-term capacity creation and commercial production. The objective is to reduce import dependence and develop a self-reliant rare earth magnet manufacturing ecosystem in the country.

Q 126. Ans. B

Explanation:

- State Bank of India was included in the RBI's 2025 list of Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs). SBI remains India's largest public sector bank and is considered systemically important because of its size, interconnectedness, and role in the financial system.
- HDFC Bank was also identified as a D-SIB by the Reserve Bank of India. Due to its large customer

base, extensive operations, and importance to the banking sector, it is classified as "too big to fail."

- ICICI Bank was included in the D-SIB list because of its significant role in India's financial and banking ecosystem.

Q 127. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** "YUVA AI for All" is a national flagship initiative launched to accelerate AI adoption and build foundational AI skills among citizens. The course is completely free of cost and is available on major digital learning platforms such as iGOT Karmayogi, DIKSHA and FutureSkills Prime, and other educational portals. Participants who successfully complete the course receive an official government certificate.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The initiative has been designed with linguistic inclusivity in mind and provides learning modules in 11 different languages. This multilingual approach seeks to make AI education accessible to people from diverse linguistic and regional backgrounds across India.

Q 128. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The PM Vishwakarma Scheme is a Central Sector Scheme launched to provide end-to-end holistic support to traditional artisans and craftspeople (Vishwakarmas) who work with their hands and tools. It covers 18 specified traditional trades, such as carpenters, boat makers, blacksmiths, potters, sculptors, cobblers, and tailors.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The scheme integrates several pillars of support, prominently featuring:
 - ✓ **Skill Upgradation:** Beneficiaries undergo Basic (5-7 days) and Advanced (15+ days) training, receiving a stipend of ₹500 per day.
 - ✓ **Toolkit Incentive:** A grant of up to ₹15,000 is provided at the beginning of basic skill training.
 - ✓ **Credit Support:** Collateral-free enterprise development loans are available (up to ₹1 lakh in the first tranche, and up to ₹2 lakh in the second) at a concessional interest rate of 5%.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The scheme is not implemented by the Ministry of Textiles. It is jointly implemented by three ministries, with the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

(MoMSME) acting as the Nodal Ministry. It is executed in close collaboration with the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) and the Department of Financial Services (DFS) under the Ministry of Finance.

Q 129. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** India is the world's largest milk producer and contributes significantly to global milk production. The growth in milk production has been supported by programmes such as the White Revolution, improved dairy infrastructure, cooperative movements, and increased participation of rural households in dairying.
- **Reason (R) is false:** In India, a substantial portion of milk is still handled through the unorganised sector, including local vendors, small dairy farmers, and informal milk markets. Organised cooperatives and private dairies process only a part of the total milk production.

Q 130. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan (Accessible India Campaign) aims to achieve universal accessibility for persons with disabilities in public buildings, transportation systems, and information & communication technology ecosystems.
- **Pair 2 is incorrectly matched:** PM Vishwakarma is not meant for large corporate industries. It is a central sector scheme designed to support traditional artisans and craftspeople such as carpenters, blacksmiths, potters, goldsmiths, tailors, and others through skill training, financial assistance, toolkit incentives, and market support.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** PM E-DRIVE aims to promote electric mobility by supporting electric vehicles, charging infrastructure, and adoption of clean transportation technologies in India.

Q 131. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The theme of the 'State of the World's Land and Water Resources for Food and Agriculture 2025 (SOLAW 2025)' report "The potential to produce more and better", the FAO flagship report focuses on the hidden and untapped potential of land, soil and water resources with

the aim of enhancing sustainable agricultural production.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Globally, agriculture uses more than 70% of freshwater resources and is associated with the majority of land degradation. The report stresses the need for sustainable management of land, soil, and water resources to ensure long-term food security and environmental sustainability.

Q 132. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Recently, India was re-elected to the UNESCO Executive Board for the 2025–29 term. The Executive Board is one of UNESCO's three constitutional organs, alongside the General Conference and the Secretariat.
- The Board consists of 58 member states elected for four-year terms. It is responsible for preparing the agenda for the General Conference, examining UNESCO's programme and budget, and making recommendations regarding the admission of new member states that are not part of the United Nations.

Q 133. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Operation Hinterland Brew is a targeted anti-narcotics initiative launched and executed by the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI), which is India's premier anti-smuggling intelligence agency operating under the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC), Ministry of Finance.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The core strategy of this operation is to detect, intercept, and dismantle clandestine synthetic drug manufacturing facilities that organized syndicates intentionally set up in remote, rural, or deep hinterland pockets. These networks utilize isolated geographical landscapes (such as agricultural areas or dense shrublands) to camouflage their infrastructure, blend into local surroundings, and evade urban law enforcement surveillance.

Q 134. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** 'Taragiri' is one of the seven advanced stealth frigates being constructed for the Indian Navy under Project 17A. These warships are being built with modern stealth technologies

to reduce radar detection and improve combat efficiency. Project 17A is a follow-up to the earlier Shivalik-class stealth frigate programme and aims to significantly strengthen India's maritime defence capabilities. The frigates are equipped with advanced weapons, surveillance systems, and network-centric warfare capabilities.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The newly delivered 'Taragiri' is named after the earlier INS Taragiri, but the original vessel was not a Kalvari-class submarine. It was a Nilgiri-class frigate commissioned into the Indian Navy in 1981 and served for many years before being decommissioned.

Q 135. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Pax Silica is a strategic economic security initiative launched by the U.S. Department of State to protect and secure high-tech supply chains. It builds a trusted network for semiconductor fabrication, AI infrastructure, and critical minerals to prevent geopolitical supply disruptions. India officially joined the coalition
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The "Pax Silica" draws from the Latin pax, meaning peace, stability, and long-term prosperity similar to historical concepts such as Pax Americana and Pax Romana. It seeks to establish a durable economic order that underwrites an AI-driven era of prosperity across partner countries. It aims to reduce coercive dependencies, safeguard materials and capabilities critical to intelligence, and enable aligned nations to develop and deploy advance technologies at scale.

Q 136. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Deepavali has been inscribed on UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage, making it the 16th Indian element on the list. The decision was announced at the 20th session of the UNESCO Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of Intangible Cultural Heritage. However, it is not a natural heritage site (which belongs to a different UNESCO category under the World Heritage Convention).

Q 137. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Pradhan Mantri Virasat Ka Samvardhan (PM VIKAS) is a Central Sector Scheme formulated by the Ministry of Minority

Affairs. It focuses entirely on the socio-economic empowerment, skilling, and livelihood generation of the six notified minority communities (Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Parsis, and Jains).

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme is aligned with the 15th Finance Commission cycle for the period up to 2025-26, not the 16th Finance Commission cycle. It focuses on the socio-economic empowerment of six notified minorities through entrepreneurship among minority women, education support for school dropouts and artisan communities across India.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** PM VIKAS acts as an umbrella initiative by seamlessly converging five erstwhile schemes of the Ministry to eliminate overlapping objectives:
 - ✓ Seekho Aur Kamao (Skilling for placement)
 - ✓ USTTAD (Upgrading traditional arts/crafts skills)
 - ✓ Hamari Dharohar (Cultural heritage preservation)
 - ✓ Nai Roshni (Leadership training for women)
 - ✓ Nai Manzil (Education and skilling for school dropouts)

Q 138. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The HAMMER (Highly Agile Modular Munition Extended Range or AASM in French) is an air-to-surface precision-guided weapon often classified as a smart glide bomb. It features a modular design consisting of a guidance kit and a range extension kit attached to standard unguided bombs (ranging from 125 kg to 1,000 kg). It has a maximum operational standoff range of up to 70 km when released from high altitudes.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** A defining feature of the HAMMER system is that it is highly resistant to electronic jamming and GNSS-denied environments. It uses a robust hybrid guidance system combining an Inertial Navigation System (INS) and GPS. If enemy electronic warfare units jam the satellite GPS signal, the internal INS autonomously guides the weapon to its target. Advanced variants also employ terminal Infrared (IR) or Laser seekers, making them completely immune to radio-frequency jamming.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Traditional unpowered glide bombs depend entirely on gravity and high-altitude release to reach far targets. In contrast, the HAMMER is fitted with a tail-mounted solid rocket

booster. This extra propulsion allows pilots to launch the weapon from low altitudes and behind covering obstacles or rough, mountainous terrain. The rocket fires post-launch, allowing the bomb to climb autonomously and strike its target in all-weather, day-and-night conditions.

Q 139. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Mahe-class vessels are Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts (ASW SWC), which are a specialized category of surface combatants and naval warships. They are engineered to replace the aging Soviet-era Abhay-class corvettes of the Indian Navy.
 - ✓ **Operational Role:** These surface warships are specifically optimized for littoral (near-coast) security grid operations. Their primary mandate is to detect, track, and neutralize subsurface threats (hostile submarines) in shallow waters, alongside secondary roles like coastal patrolling, mine-laying, and search-and-rescue (SAR) missions.
 - ✓ **Indigenous Architecture:** INS Mahe (the lead ship of this class) was constructed by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) and formally commissioned into the Indian Navy's fleet. It features over 80% indigenous content, relying on technologies from domestic entities like DRDO (for the Abhay hull-mounted sonar), BEL (for combat management systems), and L&T (for advanced torpedo launchers).

Q 140. Ans. A

Explanation:

About Siliserh Lake, Rajasthan

- It is a human-made freshwater lake and wetland, now recognised as a Ramsar site.
- It is a crucial waterbody in a semi-arid region, serving both ecological and human needs.
- It is located in the Alwar district, around 8 miles southwest of Alwar city.
- It lies within the buffer zone of the Sariska Tiger Reserve, enhancing its ecological and eco-tourism value.
- Notable Species Found
 - ✓ River tern (*Sterna aurantia*) - Vulnerable
 - ✓ Tiger (*Panthera tigris*) - Endangered

About Kopra Jalashay, Chhattisgarh

- It is a reservoir-type wetland designated as a Ramsar site.

- It will serve as Chhattisgarh's first Ramsar site.
- It is located near Bilaspur in the upper catchments of the Mahanadi River.
- It is characterised by extensive open waters and shallow, nutrient-rich backwaters, forming a mosaic of habitats.
- Notable Species Found
 - ✓ Greater spotted eagle (*Aquila clanga*) - Vulnerable
 - ✓ Egyptian vulture - Endangered (*Neophron percnopterus*)

Q 141. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Hansa-3 NG (New Generation) has been completely conceptualised, designed, and developed indigenously by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Aerospace Laboratories (CSIR-NAL) based in Bengaluru. It is an upgraded, highly modernised variant of the original HANSA-3 aircraft, which was first flown in the late 1990s. The 'NG' version was specifically built to address the contemporary requirements of Indian flying clubs.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Hansa-3 NG is an all-composite aircraft. The usage of advanced composite materials (like carbon-fiber reinforced polymers) makes its airframe exceptionally lightweight, highly resistant to corrosion, and structurally durable compared to traditional metal trainers.

Q 142. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Justice Surya Kant was appointed as the 53rd Chief Justice of India, succeeding Chief Justice B.R. Gavai. He earlier served as a judge of the Supreme Court and also as Chief Justice of the Himachal Pradesh High Court.
- Prem Kumar, a senior BJP leader from Bihar, was elected as the Speaker of the Bihar Legislative Assembly. He has previously served in ministerial positions in the Bihar government.
- Usha Janakiraman was appointed as an Executive Director (ED) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). She has handled important departments related to supervision and financial regulation within RBI.
- Vikram Sahu serves as the CEO of Bank of America India and is also associated with the bank's investment banking and capital markets operations in the Asia-Pacific region.

Q 143. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu appointed his military secretary, Major General Roman Gofman, a senior officer with no intelligence background, as the next director of the Mossad.
- Andrej Babiš has been serving as the Prime Minister of the Czech Republic since his swearing-in after the 2025 elections. This is confirmed by the official Government of the Czech Republic portal.
- José Antonio Kast was sworn in as President of Chile in March 2026.

Q 144. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Central Government assigned the additional charge of Director General of the Border Security Force to Praveen Kumar, who was already serving as the Director General of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP).
- The appointment was made as an interim arrangement following the vacancy in the top post of the BSF. The BSF functions under the Ministry of Home Affairs and is India's primary border guarding force, responsible mainly for guarding the India–Pakistan and India–Bangladesh borders.

Q 145. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- Harmanpreet Kaur was appointed as the first-ever female brand ambassador of Punjab National Bank. The announcement was made during an event themed “Banking On Champions” at the bank's corporate office in New Delhi.

Q 146. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Ramgarh Vishdhari Tiger Reserve is located in the Bundi district of Rajasthan. It was notified as Rajasthan's fourth Tiger Reserve under the centrally sponsored Project Tiger programme. Before its inclusion, Rajasthan had three tiger reserves — Ranthambore, Sariska and Mukundra Hills. It contains dry deciduous forests, grasslands and riverine ecosystems that support a rich diversity of wildlife.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The reserve forms part of the larger Mukundra–Ranthambore tiger landscape and plays an important ecological role as a wildlife corridor. It connects Ranthambore Tiger Reserve

with Mukundra Hills Tiger Reserve, enabling the movement and dispersal of tigers between these protected areas. Such corridors are significant for maintaining genetic diversity and reducing habitat fragmentation. The landscape also supports other wildlife species such as leopards, sloth bears, hyenas and several herbivores.

Q 147. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- Kopra Reservoir was recently designated as a Wetland of International Importance under the Ramsar Convention. The reservoir is located in the state of Chhattisgarh and is recognised for its ecological significance, biodiversity and role in supporting wetland-dependent species. Its inclusion in the Ramsar List strengthens wetland conservation efforts in central India and highlights the importance of sustainable management of freshwater ecosystems.

Q 148. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Assertion is correct:** Sudan has approved the establishment of a Russian naval facility on its Red Sea coast, which would become Russia's first naval base in Africa. The move is strategically significant for Russia as it seeks a permanent military presence in the Red Sea region and greater access to warm-water maritime routes.
- **The Reason statement correctly explains the Assertion:** Sudan occupies a highly strategic location along the Red Sea. The Red Sea connects the Indian Ocean with the Mediterranean Sea through the Suez Canal, making it one of the world's most important global shipping corridors. Control or access to this route enhances naval reach, trade influence and geopolitical presence.

Q 149. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Venu Srinivasan, Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor Company, was honoured with the prestigious CII Quality Ratna Award 2025 at the 33rd CII Excellence Summit 2025, recognizing his contribution to quality-driven industrial growth and manufacturing excellence in India.
- Leonardo DiCaprio, one of Hollywood's most celebrated actors, has been honoured as TIME's Entertainer of the Year 2025.
- In recognition of her vow to be meat-free, fierce

dedication to protecting wildlife, tireless advocacy on behalf of community animals, and compassionate efforts to promote empathy for all living, feeling beings, People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals India (PETA India) has named award-winning Bollywood actor Raveena Tandon its 2025 Person of the Year.

- Jay Shah received the Outstanding Achievement Award for Contributions to Indian Cricket at the CNN-News18 Indian of the Year Awards 2025, not the main “Indian of the Year 2025” award.

Q 150. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) is jointly published by Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and Climate Action Network International.
 - ✓ In CCPI 2025, India ranked 10th globally.
 - ✓ The top three positions remained vacant as no country achieved the required “very high” overall performance category.
 - ✓ Among the ranked countries, Denmark, United Kingdom and Morocco occupied the highest positions after the vacant ranks.
- Asia Power Index 2025 is published by the Lowy Institute, an Australia-based think tank.
 - ✓ The index measures the relative power of countries in Asia across parameters such as economic capability, military strength, resilience, diplomatic influence and future resources.
 - ✓ In the Asia Power Index 2025, India ranked 3rd with a score of 40.0.
 - ✓ The top five countries in the index were:
 - United States
 - China
 - India
 - Japan
 - Russia
- Global AI Vibrancy Index 2025 is published by Stanford University through the Stanford Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI).
 - ✓ India ranked 3rd in the index with a score of 21.59.
 - ✓ The top five countries in the index were:
 - United States
 - China
 - India
 - South Korea
 - United Kingdom
- The 5th edition of the Women, Peace and Security Index 2025/26 was published by the Georgetown Institute for Women, Peace and Security and the Peace Research Institute Oslo with support from the Government of Norway.
 - ✓ The index assesses women’s inclusion, justice and security across countries.
 - ✓ India ranked 131st in the index with a score of 0.607.

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